

Data Pre-processing

1. **Load dataset**
 - Import dataset into a DataFrame. (5 features)
2. **Explore dataset**
 - Check shape (rows, columns).
 - List column names.
 - Inspect data types and summary statistics.
3. **Handle missing values**
 - Identify missing data.
 - Impute missing numeric values using statistical methods (mean/median) and ML imputers.
 - For categorical variables, impute with mode or create a separate category.
4. **Encode categorical variables**
 - Convert categorical features to numeric form using techniques like:
 - Label Encoding (for ordinal variables)
 - One-Hot Encoding (for nominal variables)
5. **Detect and handle outliers**
 - Outliers can affect some models, though decision trees are generally robust.
 - Use methods like IQR or Z-score to detect or ML methods like **DBSCAN**.
6. **Balance the dataset (if imbalanced classes) (atleast one)**
 - If class distribution is skewed, apply techniques like:
 - Oversampling (SMOTE)
 - Undersampling
 - Class weighting in model
7. **Data transformation (if needed) (atleast one)**
 - Log-transform or normalize skewed features (usually more relevant for algorithms sensitive to scale).
8. **Split dataset**
 - Use train-test split (e.g., 70-30 or 80-20) to divide data into training and testing sets.